

# CAT

## *Marjaryasana*

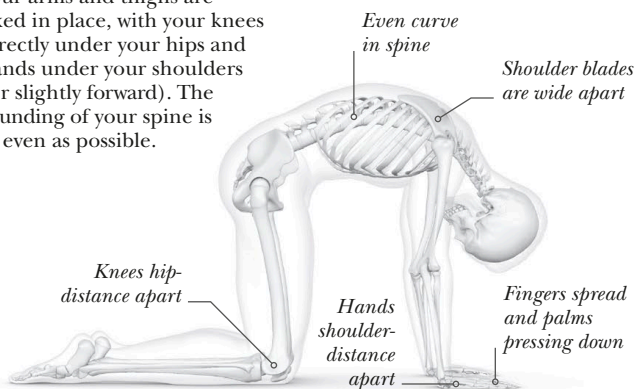
**This is a gentle kneeling pose** that takes the position of a scared cat, warming up joints in your spine, hips, and shoulders. Try exhaling as you move into the pose. This is often done with the next pose, Cow, by flowing from Cat to Cow with the exhale and inhale.

## THE BIG PICTURE

Your back muscles stretch while the muscles on the front of your body—including your chest and abdominal muscles—engage. Muscles in your arms work to stabilize you. Your rib cage is compressed, helping to facilitate a deep exhale into the pose.

### ALIGNMENT

Your arms and thighs are fixed in place, with your knees directly under your hips and hands under your shoulders (or slightly forward). The rounding of your spine is as even as possible.



### Lower torso

Your lumbar spine is in flexion, stretching your **quadratus lumborum**. Your **abdominals** engage to compress your abdomen, squeezing your belly button in toward your spine. Your pelvis is in a posterior pelvic tilt.

